

TECHNICAL SPECIFICATION

Interactive Ideas

Game Engine — v1 Ship Scope

Field	Value
Product	Interactive Ideas — Venture Quest World
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Author	Aryan Interactive Ideas
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This document specifies what is built for the first shipped version of the Interactive Ideas game engine. It is not a feature wishlist. Every item in this spec ships. Everything not in this spec does not.

What Gets Built

Everything required to ship. Grouped by domain. One line per item.

Project
One project type: Venture
8 stages: Ideation, Research, Validation, Offer Design, Build & Deliver, Launch, Iteration, Scale
Full checkpoint structure per stage (3-6 checkpoints per stage, as specced)
3 tasks per checkpoint (T1 Easy, T2 Medium, T3 Stretch). Advance on 2/3.
Gold checkpoint state on 3/3 completion
Project creation flow: name, brief, manual skill and industry tag selection (flat list, no AI suggestions)

World Map & Rendering
Phaser 3 canvas mounted inside React at /map route
Snake-path overworld with 8 biome zones rendered left to right
Checkpoint nodes on path: locked / active / standard-complete / gold-complete states
Two-layer world brightness system: accumulated base (per completed stage) + stage layer (current task completion %)
Brightness formula: base = completed stages x 8.5%, capped at 60%. Stage layer = current stage task completion x 40%. Sum drives overall brightness.
Stage brightness resets to accumulated base when entering a new stage
Biome visual skins for all 8 Venture stages

Personas
2 pixel sprite personas: one male, one female
Each sprite: 32x48px native, rendered at 96x144px (3x scale)
Idle animation loop per persona
Walk cycle per persona
Persona selection screen shown once at project creation
Selected persona floats above current active checkpoint node on map

Boss System
3 Super Bosses built in full (randomly assigned at project creation)
Per Super Boss: entrance animation, slay animation, retreat animation

Boss System
Super Boss silhouette visible across entire map from project start
Super Boss becomes fully rendered at final stage
8 stage-level checkpoint mini-bosses (one per Venture stage)
Per mini-boss: weakens visually as stage checkpoints are completed, slay on stage complete, retreat on partial stage complete
Boss animations are standardised in intensity — not scaled by AI quality score

Checkpoint Crossing Animations
6 crossing pattern types implemented (Seal Break, Rune Inscription, Beacon Lighting, Bridge Repair, Compass Calibration, Ward Placement)
Standard variant (2/3 tasks) and Gold variant (3/3 tasks) for each pattern
Pattern assigned per stage at build time
No inter-checkpoint gameplay — crossing resolves directly to next node

AI Scoring
AI scores each task submission on 4 dimensions: completeness, specificity, evidence, originality (0-3 each, total 0-12)
Score maps to quality tier: Low (0-4), Standard (5-8), High (9-12)
Tier increments the Valuation Score shown as a project-level metric to the user
Valuation Score always increases — quality determines magnitude of increment per stage
AI model: open-weight (free tier), frontier (Explorer Pro)
AI scoring does not affect boss animation intensity — bosses are standardised

Progression (Frontend Animation Only — Backend Already Exists)
XP bar fill animation on points earned
Level-up animation sequence: edge burst, counter spin, title reveal, tool unlock cards (2s total, skippable after 0.5s)
Phase transition level-up (6>7, 15>16, 28>29, 39>40) additionally shows world-map area unlock animation
Badge award animation: interrupt flash, badge drop and bounce, reveal card with name and rarity (4s; Legendary unskippable)
Rarity-variant badge animations: Common through Legendary

Collaboration & Social (Already in Codebase — Wire Up Only)
Contribution required at every checkpoint completion and stage completion
Contribution formats: text (min 50 words), audio, video, image, file (PDF, PPT, XLS, DOC)
Gold checkpoint completion fires community feed notification
Collaboration invite and shared project view connected to game map state

Tools
Write: rich text editor with word count minimum enforcement
Upload: file attach supporting all Contribution formats
Table: structured column-labelled table builder
Map/Canvas: freeform whiteboard
Survey: create, distribute, collect
Poll: 2-4 option community-broadcastable poll
Link: URL input with auto-preview and annotation
Self-report: guided text confirmation form
Journal: private running log with selective share
Kanban: task board with custom columns
Calendar: milestone scheduling

HUD
XP bar
Level number
Current stage name
Checkpoint progress counter (e.g. 3 / 5)
Streak counter
Valuation Score (project quality metric)
Audio toggle (master mute with volume slider on expand)

Audio
Ambient loop per biome (8 total)
Checkpoint crossing SFX: 6 patterns x 2 variants

Audio
Level-up fanfare
Badge award SFX: variant per rarity tier
Super Boss entrance theme: 3 tracks (one per built boss)
Mini-boss stage theme: 8 tracks (one per Venture stage)
UI action SFX: click, confirm, error
All audio via Howler.js. Deferred init until first user interaction.

Not Built in v1
Remaining 9 Super Bosses from the full pool
Additional project types (Academic, Lab, Creative)
Character creator and photo-to-pixel persona pipeline
Inter-checkpoint gameplay (henchmen, treasure chests)
Corruption as a mechanic or meter
Collaborator matching algorithm
AI tag suggestion on project creation
Flare system
Weekly quests and leagues
Mentor tier (Level 40+)

1. Project Structure

1.1 Project Type

One project type ships: Venture. All 8 stages are built in full. No other template types are built in v1.

1.2 Stage Structure

#	Stage	Setting / Biome	Mini-Boss	Checkpoints
1	Ideation	The Village	Fog of Vagueness	4
2	Research	The Forest	Pathwarden Wraith	5
3	Validation	The Arena	Advocate of Comfortable Lies	4
4	Offer Design	The Artisan's Quarter	Unfinished Golem	5
5	Build & Deliver	The Mine	Collapse Specter	6
6	Launch	The Harbour	Harbourmaster of Hesitation	3
7	Iteration	The Crossroads Town	Babel Merchant	4
8	Scale	The Capital	Iron Bureaucrat	5

1.3 Checkpoint & Task Rules

Rule	Spec
Tasks per checkpoint	3 — T1 Easy, T2 Medium, T3 Stretch
Advance condition	2 of 3 tasks completed
Gold checkpoint condition	All 3 tasks completed
T1 point weight	20% of checkpoint point value
T2 point weight	20% of checkpoint point value
T3 point weight	35% of checkpoint point value
Gold bonus	+25% on top of full task completion
Contribution requirement	Required text or media post before checkpoint can be marked complete

1.4 Project Creation Flow

1. User navigates to /project/new
2. Selects Venture as project type (only option in v1)

3. Writes project brief (free text, no minimum enforced at creation)
4. Manually selects skill tags (flat list, max 5) and industry tags (flat list, max 4)
5. No AI suggestion at creation — tags are user-selected only
6. Selects persona sprite (male or female)
7. World launches at /map — Stage 1 / Checkpoint 1 is the active node

2. World Map & Lighting System

2.1 Rendering Stack

Layer	Technology	Responsibility
Game canvas	Phaser 3	World map, biomes, checkpoint nodes, persona sprite, boss silhouettes, brightness layer
UI overlays	React + Framer Motion	HUD, task panels, contribution modal, checkpoint detail drawer
Panel z-index	CSS z-index stacking	React panels sit above Phaser canvas. Phaser stays mounted. No teardown on panel open.
Route	/map	Single route. Project ID passed as query param.

2.2 Two-Layer Brightness System

World brightness is the sum of two independent layers. Both are driven entirely by completion data already present in the backend. No additional state is required.

Layer	Source Signal	Formula	Range	Resets?
Accumulated base	Number of fully completed prior stages	$\text{completed_stages} \times 8.57\%$, capped at 60%	0% – 60%	Never. Accumulates across the full project lifespan.
Stage layer	Task completion % within current stage	$\frac{\text{current_stage_tasks_done}}{\text{current_stage_tasks_total}} \times 40\%$	0% – 40%	Yes. Resets to 0% when user enters a new stage.
World brightness	Sum of both layers	$\text{accumulated_base} + \text{stage_layer}$	0% – 100%	—

IMPLEMENTATION NOTE

At Stage 1 start: brightness = 0% + 0% = 0% (darkest state).

After completing Stage 1 fully and entering Stage 2: brightness = 8.57% + 0% = 8.57%.

Mid-Stage 5 with 50% of tasks done: brightness = (4 x 8.57%) + (50% x 40%) = 34.28% + 20% = 54.28%.

Final stage fully complete: brightness = (7 x 8.57%) + 40% = 60% + 40% = 100%.

Brightness drives a single Phaser post-processing filter (brightness/contrast). No per-biome custom logic required.

2.3 Checkpoint Node States

State	Condition	Visual
Locked	Prior checkpoint not yet completed	Dimmed node, lock icon, no interaction
Active	Current checkpoint — prior complete	Pulse glow, persona sprite above node
Partial	1 of 3 tasks done	Amber glow, partial crack on node seal
Standard complete	2 of 3 tasks done	White-blue glow, seal shattered, lit
Gold complete	3 of 3 tasks done	Gold burst particle effect on completion, gold crown above node permanently

2.4 Stage Boundary Behaviour

- On standard stage completion (final checkpoint 2/3): mini-boss slay animation plays, biome clears, next biome zone unlocks and scrolls into view.
- On gold stage completion (final checkpoint 3/3): extended slay animation with biome transformation plays before transition.
- On entering new stage: stage layer resets to 0%, accumulated base increments by 8.57%.
- Camera scrolls right to new stage zone. Persona walks to first checkpoint node.

3. Personas

3.1 Sprite Specifications

Property	Value
Sprites built	2 — one male, one female
Native resolution	32 x 48 px
Rendered resolution	96 x 144 px (3x scale, nearest-neighbour)
Colour depth	16-colour palette derived from platform design system
Format	PNG sprite sheet with transparent background
Animation frames	Idle loop: 4 frames. Walk cycle: 6 frames.
Frame rate	8 fps for idle, 12 fps for walk
Bone rig	Not required — frame-by-frame pixel animation only

3.2 Persona Behaviour in World

- Idle animation plays at all times when persona is stationary above active checkpoint node.
- Walk animation plays during stage transition scroll (persona walks right toward new stage zone).
- Persona is rendered on the Phaser canvas layer, above the world background, below UI overlays.
- No persona visible on locked or completed checkpoint nodes — only on the active node.
- Persona selection is shown once at project creation. Cannot be changed after project starts.

4. Boss System

4.1 Super Bosses — 3 Built

3 Super Bosses are built for v1. One is assigned randomly at project creation and persists for the full project lifespan. The other 9 from the full pool are not built in v1.

Boss	Type	Thematic Core	Defeated By
The Unraveller	Ancient Void Serpent	Doubt and loss of direction	Completing the final stage as a coherent whole
The Pale Architect	Undead Perfectionist Titan	Paralysis and perfectionism	Completing any final checkpoint despite imperfection
The Gravemind	Necromantic Hive Intelligence	Fear of failure and past attempts	Each completed checkpoint buries one past failure permanently

4.2 Super Boss Animation States

State	Trigger	Animation
Silhouette	Project created — boss assigned	Faint dark outline visible at far right edge of world map. Opacity 15%.
Present	Stage 5 entered	Silhouette opacity increases to 50%. Slow idle movement begins.
Foreground	Stage 7 entered	Boss fully rendered in foreground at 100% opacity. Idle animation active.
Slay	All 8 stages complete — gold final checkpoint	Unique per-boss slay cinematic. Duration 3-4s. Unskippable.
Slay (standard)	All 8 stages complete — standard final checkpoint	Standardised retreat animation shared across all 3 bosses. Duration 2s.

STANDARDISED ANIMATIONS

Boss animation intensity is not affected by AI quality score. All users with the same completion state see the same animation. The Valuation Score is the only output visible to users from AI scoring.

4.3 Stage Mini-Bosses — 8 Built

One mini-boss per Venture stage. Mini-bosses weaken visually as stage checkpoints are completed and are resolved at stage completion.

Stage	Mini-Boss	Weakens As...	Slay Condition
Ideation	Fog of Vagueness	Each checkpoint burns away a fog bank. Village becomes visible.	Final Ideation checkpoint complete
Research	Pathwarden Wraith	Each checkpoint breaks a trail-scrambling sigil.	Final Research checkpoint complete
Validation	Advocate of Comfortable Lies	Each checkpoint silences one false testimony.	Final Validation checkpoint complete
Offer Design	Unfinished Golem	Each checkpoint adds a component to the binding rune, slowing the golem.	Final Offer Design checkpoint complete
Build & Deliver	Collapse Specter	Each checkpoint reinforces a tunnel section, driving specter back.	Final Build & Deliver checkpoint complete
Launch	Harbourmaster of Hesitation	Each checkpoint satisfies one of its objections.	Final Launch checkpoint complete
Iteration	Babel Merchant	Each checkpoint renders one of its false maps worthless.	Final Iteration checkpoint complete
Scale	Iron Bureaucrat	Each checkpoint earns a permit or breaks a regulation.	Final Scale checkpoint complete

4.4 Mini-Boss Animation States

State	Condition	Visual
Full strength	0 checkpoints completed in stage	Mini-boss at full opacity, active idle animation, corruption-dark biome
Weakened (partial)	1 or more but not all checkpoints complete	Opacity decreases proportionally. Biome partially brightens.
Retreat	Stage complete at 2/3 final checkpoint	Standardised retreat animation. Mini-boss exits to stage border.
Slay	Stage complete at 3/3 gold final checkpoint	Per-boss slay animation unique to that stage. Biome transforms.

5. Checkpoint Crossing Animations

6 crossing animation patterns. Each pattern has a Standard variant (2/3 tasks) and a Gold variant (3/3 tasks). Pattern is assigned to a stage at build time and does not change at runtime. No inter-checkpoint gameplay — on crossing, Phaser transitions directly to the next node.

Pattern	Standard — 2/3	Gold — 3/3 additional	Audio
Seal Break	Seal cracks and shatters. Gate swings open. Persona steps through.	Seal explodes in gold particles. Gate transforms to gilded arch. Gold crown placed on node.	Crack SFX > gate creak > flash. Gold: explosion > transformation > fanfare chord.
Rune Inscription	Two of three rune lines inscribe on stone tablet. Tablet pulses.	All three lines complete. Tablet rises and hovers. Visible to community feed.	Ink fill > glow pulse > stone rumble. Gold: levitation > secondary inscription chime.
Beacon Lighting	Watchtower beacon ignites. Visible on map. Brightness increments.	Beacon burns gold/white flame. Community feed notified as gold checkpoint.	Ignition > light spread > distant flicker. Gold: colour shift > community ping.
Bridge Repair	Bridge self-assembles plank by plank. Persona walks across.	Bridge upgrades: stone to marble, rope to gilded chain. Plaque at crest.	Build SFX > settle click > footsteps. Gold: upgrade whoosh > plaque appear > fanfare.
Compass Calibration	Ground compass snaps to new heading. Fog lifts from path ahead.	Compass emits directional beam to next checkpoint node.	Spin > lock click > fog dissolve. Gold: sustained beam tone > community chime.
Ward Placement	Ward stone planted. Party boundary expands. Nearby area clears.	Ward grows ornate. Second ward stone appears at node permanently.	Plant SFX > glow spread > hum. Gold: growth creak > second stone thud > resonant tone.

Stage	Pattern Assigned
Ideation	Compass Calibration
Research	Beacon Lighting
Validation	Seal Break
Offer Design	Rune Inscription
Build & Deliver	Bridge Repair
Launch	Ward Placement
Iteration	Compass Calibration

Stage	Pattern Assigned
Scale	Seal Break

6. AI Scoring & Valuation Score

6.1 Scoring Model

AI scores every task submission immediately on completion. Scoring is non-blocking — the user can mark a task complete and move on. The score is computed asynchronously and the Valuation Score updates when the result returns.

Dimension	What is assessed	Score range
Completeness	Does the submission address what the task asked for?	0 – 3
Specificity	Are claims concrete and grounded, or vague?	0 – 3
Evidence	Is the reasoning or finding supported by real data, quotes, or sources?	0 – 3
Originality	Does the submission add something beyond the minimum task requirement?	0 – 3
Total	Sum of all four dimensions	0 – 12

6.2 Quality Tier Mapping

Total Score	Quality Tier	Valuation Score Increment
0 – 4	Low	Small increment. Valuation grows minimally.
5 – 8	Standard	Moderate increment. Valuation grows as expected.
9 – 12	High	Full increment. Valuation grows significantly.

6.3 Valuation Score Display

- Displayed in HUD as a running project metric throughout the project lifespan.
- Always increases — quality determines magnitude of increase per stage advance, never direction.
- Displayed as an INR-denominated figure (e.g. Rs. 12L pre-seed equivalent). Framing is indicative, not financial advice.
- Score is per-project, not per-user. Different projects have independent Valuation Scores.
- Valuation Score does not affect boss animation intensity. Bosses are standardised.

6.4 AI Model Tiering

Tier	Model	Behaviour
Free	Open-weight (e.g. Mistral 7B, Llama 3.1 8B)	Scoring runs. Feedback is adequate. Response depth is visibly simpler.
Explorer Pro	Frontier (Claude Haiku or Sonnet)	Scoring runs. Richer qualitative feedback returned per dimension. Conversion driver.

7. Progression Animations

Levels, XP, and Achievements are fully implemented on the backend. This section specifies only the frontend animation layer required to make those backend events visible to the user.

7.1 XP Bar

Property	Spec
Location	HUD — persistent, always visible
Fill animation	Smooth interpolation over 600ms, ease-out, on every points-earning event
Level threshold	Bar fills to 100% then empties to 0% as level increments
Overflow handling	If a single event earns enough XP to skip a level, bar rapidly fills to 100%, triggers level-up, resets and continues fill in one chained sequence

7.2 Level-Up Animation Sequence

Step	Duration	Spec
1. Edge burst	0.3s	Full-screen purple edge flash. Covers entire viewport including Phaser canvas.
2. Counter spin	0.5s	Level number in HUD spins from old value to new value. Bounce easing on land.
3. Title reveal	0.4s	New level title fades in with gold glow. Font: Plus Jakarta Sans bold.
4. Tool/unlock cards	0.8s	Any newly unlocked tools or abilities appear as floating cards above HUD. Fade in staggered.
5. Fanfare	2.0s total	Ascending arpeggio with percussion. Plays under steps 1-4.
Skip	Skippable after 0.5s	Tap/click anywhere after step 1 completes jumps to end state.

PHASE TRANSITION LEVELS

Levels 6>7, 15>16, 28>29, 39>40 additionally trigger a world-map area unlock animation (1.2s) after step 3. A new region of the broader platform world becomes visible on a persistent world map layer. This does not affect the Venture quest map.

7.3 Badge Award Animation Sequence

Step	Duration	Spec
1. Interrupt flash	0.1s	Brief white flash on viewport. Signals something happened.
2. Badge drop	0.6s	Badge sprite falls from top of screen at 200% scale. Spring bounce to 100% on land.
3. Reveal card	0.4s	Badge name, tagline, and rarity tier shown in overlay card. Auto-dismisses after 4s or on tap.

Rarity	Additional animation	Dismissible?
Common	No additional effect	Yes — auto-dismiss 4s
Uncommon	Soft gold shimmer on badge sprite	Yes — auto-dismiss 4s
Rare	Particle burst on land	Yes — auto-dismiss 4s
Epic	Extended particle burst + colour pulse	Yes — auto-dismiss 4s
Legendary	Full-screen gold particle burst before step 1. Reveal card does not auto-dismiss.	No — manual dismiss only

8. Tools

Tools are the submission interfaces for tasks. Each task type maps to exactly one tool. All 11 tool types ship in v1.

Tool	Task type	Minimum to submit	Key behaviour
Write	Write	50 words	Rich text editor. Word count shown. Submission blocked below minimum.
Table	Table	At least 2 rows + headers	Column-labelled table builder. Rows can be added dynamically.
Map / Canvas	Map/Canvas	At least 1 element placed	Freeform whiteboard. Post-its, shapes, arrows, image drops.
Survey	Survey	Survey created and at least 1 response collected	Create questions, distribute via link, view compiled responses.
Poll	Poll	Poll created and published	2-4 options. Broadcastable to community feed.
Link	Link	At least 1 URL with annotation	URL input with auto-preview. Annotation field required per link.
Upload	Upload	At least 1 file attached	Accepts PDF, PPT, XLS, DOC, PNG, JPG, MP4, MP3.
Self-report	Self-report	Form completed and confirmed	Guided text fields. Final confirmation checkbox required.
Journal	Journal	At least 1 entry written	Private running log. Per-entry toggle for selective share.
Kanban	Kanban	Board created with at least 2 columns and 1 card	Drag-and-drop. Columns and card labels customisable.
Calendar	Calendar	At least 1 event or milestone placed	Week/month view. Milestone markers distinguishable from events.

8.1 Universal Tools

These are available to all users at all times, independent of task type:

Tool	Function
Contribution	Required post at every checkpoint and stage completion. Formats: text (50+ words), audio, video, image, file. Auto-shares to project feed at milestones.
Group Chat	Real-time text chat for project collaborators. Persists per project.

Tool	Function
Video Call	Live video session within the project team. Session history not stored.
Kanban / To-Do	Available as a standalone project management tool in addition to being a task tool type.
Calendar	Available as a standalone timeline tool in addition to being a task tool type.

9. HUD

The HUD is a React overlay positioned above the Phaser canvas via z-index. It is always visible during an active project session. All data it displays comes from the existing backend.

Element	Data source	Update behaviour
XP bar	user.xp / user.xp_to_next_level	Animated fill on every points event. See Section 7.1.
Level number	user.level	Updates as part of level-up animation sequence. See Section 7.2.
Stage name	project.current_stage.name	Updates on stage transition. No animation — immediate swap.
Checkpoint progress	project.current_stage.checkpoints_complete / total	Updates immediately on checkpoint completion. Format: X / Y.
Streak counter	user.streak_days	Updates at midnight. No animation.
Valuation Score	project.valuation_score	Updates when AI scoring returns. Ticker-style count-up animation on change.
Audio toggle	localStorage: audio_enabled, audio_volume	Persistent across sessions. Master mute toggle with volume slider on expand.

10. Audio

All audio is handled by Howler.js. Audio initialisation is deferred until first user interaction to comply with browser autoplay policies. All volume settings persist in localStorage.

Audio asset	Count	Format	Loop	Notes
Biome ambient loop	8	MP3 + OGG fallback	Yes	One per Venture stage. Crossfade 1s on stage transition.
Checkpoint crossing SFX	12	MP3	No	6 patterns x 2 variants (standard / gold). One-shot on trigger.
Level-up fanfare	1	MP3	No	Ascending arpeggio with percussion. 2s.
Badge award SFX	5	MP3	No	One per rarity tier (Common, Uncommon, Rare, Epic, Legendary).
Super Boss entrance theme	3	MP3	No	One per built boss. 4s. Plays on boss entering foreground state.
Mini-boss stage theme	8	MP3	Yes	One per Venture stage. Layered under biome ambient. Lower volume.
UI action SFX	3	MP3	No	Click, confirm, error. Kept muted relative to world audio.

Setting	Default	Persists?
Master volume	80%	Yes — localStorage
Music volume	70%	Yes — localStorage
SFX volume	90%	Yes — localStorage
Mute	Off	Yes — localStorage

11. Animation Timing Standards

Animation	Duration	Easing	Skippable?
Panel open / close	280ms	cubic-bezier(0.4, 0, 0.2, 1)	N/A
Stage biome transition scroll	800ms	ease-in-out	No
Persona walk to next stage	Tied to scroll	Sync with camera	No
Checkpoint crossing — standard	1.5s – 2s	Per pattern spec	No
Checkpoint crossing — gold	2.5s – 3.5s	Per pattern spec	No
Mini-boss slay	2s	Standardised	No
Mini-boss retreat	1.5s	Standardised	No
Super Boss slay — standard	2s	Standardised	No
Super Boss slay — gold (unique)	3s – 4s	Per boss spec	No
Task completion checkmark	200ms	Spring bounce	N/A
Valuation Score tick-up	600ms	ease-out	N/A
XP bar fill	600ms	ease-out	N/A
Level-up full sequence	2s	Per step spec	After 0.5s
Badge award — Common to Epic	4s	Per step spec	Yes, on tap
Badge award — Legendary	4s + gold burst 0.5s	Per step spec	No
World brightness interpolation	Real-time continuous	Linear	N/A

12. Collaboration & Social

Collaboration and social feed are already implemented in the codebase. This section specifies only what the game engine must wire up to those existing systems.

Integration point	Trigger	Action
Gold checkpoint community notification	User completes 3/3 tasks at any checkpoint	Fire event to existing social feed. Feed renders as gold checkpoint card with project name, stage, and checkpoint name.
Stage completion feed post	User completes final checkpoint of any stage	Fire event to social feed. Feed renders as stage completion card.
Contribution post	User submits Contribution at checkpoint or stage completion	Contribution is attached to the social feed post for that checkpoint/stage. Formats: text, audio, video, image, file.
Collaborator map state	A collaborator completes a task	Map reflects updated completion state in real time for all project members. Persona on map is always the viewing user's own persona.

OUT OF SCOPE FOR V1

Flare system, collaborator matching algorithm, community discovery feed, and AI tag suggestions at project creation are all deferred to v2. The social feed that already exists shows content from projects the user is a member of only.

Appendix — Not Built in v1

The following items are explicitly out of scope for the first shipped version. They are listed here to prevent scope creep during build.

Item	Reason deferred
Academic, Lab, and Creative project types	One template validates the core loop. Expand post-launch.
Remaining 9 Super Bosses	Only 3 are built. Pool expansion is post-launch.
Character creator (pixel sprite builder)	Art and engineering scope. v2 Explorer Pro feature.
Photo-to-pixel persona conversion	Server-side pipeline complexity. v2 Explorer Pro feature.
Inter-checkpoint gameplay (henchmen, chests)	Adds game scope without validating core loop.
Corruption as a mechanic or meter	Corruption is aesthetic only in v1. No mechanic required.
Collaborator matching algorithm	Matching requires enough users to be meaningful. Build after launch.
AI tag suggestion at project creation	Tags are user-selected from flat list in v1. AI suggestion is v2.
Flare system	Community help mechanic. Requires active user base to function.
Weekly quests and leagues	Retention mechanic for established users. v2.
Mentor tier and mentee mechanics (Level 40+)	Long-horizon feature. Not reachable by any v1 user for years.
Third persona sprite (magical creature)	Deferred per scope decision. v2.